



IIT ROORKEE



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CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 41: Facing the Interview

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“Every interview ... is an interpersonal drama with a developing plot” (Pool, 1957).



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The Day of Interview

- ❑ Carrying forward one's area of expertise, it is essential to present one's knowledge in the best possible way during the interview.
- ❑ Interview space offers an opportunity for candidates to:
 - be vigilant throughout
 - display one's talent and skills
 - reassess and self-introspect one's position
 - submit relevant queries and seek clarity
- ❑ Concerning the above merits, interviewees should utilise the opportunity to the fullest.

Apparels for Interview

- ❑ One's attire for the interview plays a crucial role in making the first impression.
- ❑ The apparel speaks for itself even before the candidate establishes rapport with the interviewer.
- ❑ Different industries expect a different set of dress codes to be followed.
- ❑ However, it is better to choose a go-to- formal attire that is usually preferred in most interview set-ups.



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Tips to Dress Properly for Interview

- Make sure to avail of the complete attire , checklist (as displayed in the image) at least a day before the interview.
- It is essential to check if the dress fits properly. Neither oversized nor too tight.
- Well-polished formal shoes add weight to one's personality.
- One must keep oneself well-groomed and neat with a proper haircut and clean shave.

"Fashion is only the attempt to realize art in living forms and social intercourse." —Francis Bacon



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Impression Management (IM)

- ❖ It is a concept employed by job recruitment experts acquainted with organisational psychology.
- ❖ Levashina and Campion suggest that IM is, "an attempt conscious or unconscious to influence the image during the process of interaction" (p. 1639).
- ❖ IM is achieved through two means:
 - Self Promotion (Presenting one's positive image)
 - Other enhancements (Developing a positive relationship with the interviewer)



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What *to do* in an interview?

- ✓ Exchange greetings.
- ✓ Employ an appropriate form of non-verbal communication.
 - ✓ Smiling, making eye- contact, nodding, leaning forward (Barrick et al., 1394).
- ✓ Listen to the interviewer carefully.
- ✓ Let the interviewer lead the conversation.
- ✓ Pause to think and reflect when facing a difficult question.

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- ✓ Clothes
 - ✓ Hairstyles
 - ✓ Facial expression
 - ✓ Way of walking & entering
 - ✓ Sitting posture
 - ✓ Way of turning back

Mannerisms to Express

organised
professional exciting
approachable
fast-paced flexible team
collaboration informative
calm
welcoming
vast
variety friendly
interesting varied
helpful fun

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What *not to do* in Interviews?

- Never show up late for the interview.
- Avoid excuses. They fetch a poor first impression.
- Avoid wearing informal clothes or having a shabby appearance.
- Do not sit unless you are asked to by the interviewer. Seek permission.
- Never answer before the interviewer has finished their question.
- Avoid beating about the bush and using ambiguous language.
- Refrain from repetition or stuttering. They explain nervousness.

Beginning of an Interview

- ✓ Exchange greetings with a firm handshake.
- ✓ Briefly introduce yourself.

The candidate shall face **generic questions** at first, such as:

- ❖ What is your area of expertise?
- ❖ How did you happen to come for this job?
- ❖ What prompted you to apply for this position?
- ❖ What makes you the right fit for this position?



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Contd...

- After the first part of the interview, the questions become more specific and focused.
- The interviewer would aim to ask mainly three types of questions to assess the candidate:
 - a. Open-ended questions
 - b. Closed-ended questions
 - c. Hypothetical questions

Types of Interview Questions

❑ Open-ended interview questions:

- Open questions aim at eliciting information of subjective value.
- Example: **Tell us about your experience with our organization so far.**

❑ Closed-ended interview questions:

- These kind of questions serve to qualitatively assess the behaviour and attitude of the candidate.

Example: **How satisfied are you with your current job role?**

❑ Hypothetical interview questions:

- These questions put the interviewee in a situational context for evaluation.

Example: **How do you imagine developing this institution's outreach?**

Frequently Asked Questions

- ❖ Can you please introduce yourself briefly?
- ❖ What attracted you to apply for a job in our organization?
- ❖ Why should we hire you?
- ❖ What are your strengths and weaknesses?
- ❖ Where do you see yourself in this organization after ten years?
- ❖ Do you prefer working alone or in groups?
- ❖ What do you prefer- status or money? And why?



Contd...

- ❖ Why do you keep changing your jobs quite often?
- ❖ Your grade point was too low in your graduation?
- ❖ What is the reason behind the gap in your degrees?
- ❖ Who has been the ideal in your life?
- ❖ What are your most rewarding or defeating experiences?
- ❖ What are your long-term and short-term goals?
- ❖ Do you have any preference for locations?



Contd...

- ❖ What do you think can be an innovative way to curb rising prices?
- ❖ Which qualities do you feel a successful professional should have?
- ❖ What would you like to change in your personality?
- ❖ What is your expected salary?
- ❖ Which skills have you acquired of late?
- ❖ What, if you are not selected?



What should one remember on the day of Interview?

- ✓ Remember to read the morning newspaper/listen to latest news.
- ✓ Get acquainted with the mode of travel to reach the interview venue.
- ✓ Understand traffic and calculate accordingly. Be punctual.
- ✓ Keep the contact details of the company in case of emergency.
- ✓ Be polite and courteous.
- ✓ Carry a cheerful face with a warm smile.
- ✓ Prepare insightful questions to ask and express your interest.

Things to Remember Post-interview

- ✓ Secure the contact of the hiring manager after finishing the interview.
- ✓ Thank the members for their time and given opportunity.
- ✓ Connect with the hiring manager to know about further steps and follow-up.
- ✓ Self-assess the delivery and performance at the interview.
- ✓ Make notes to remember key points about the company or the interview.
- ✓ Send supporting documents to the company, if required.
- ✓ Keep calm and wait for the follow-up email from the company.

“It is never too late to be what you might have been.”
-George Eliot

Thank You

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